

Enpal | Termin für Dein Interview | Data Engineering Lead@June 25, 2026 10:11 AM

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Notes

- The interview was largely a **fit and leadership-depth conversation**, not a hard technical screen.[linkedin](#)
- Daria introduced the role as a **startup inside a startup** at Enpal: small, young, motivated, and still missing a dedicated team lead.[linkedin](#)
- She framed the core need as **bringing structure, order, and coordination** to a decentralized team, not just writing models.[linkedin](#)
- She asked for your **leadership scope** at Vestiaire, and you explained that you were heavily hands-on early on, then shifted toward more managerial work as the team grew.[Resume.pdf+1](#)
- You gave a strong example about rebuilding the **transportation data table** into a trustworthy source of truth using microservices/Kafka-based data and stakeholder alignment.[Resume.pdf](#)
- You also described the **data mesh pilot** as a leadership example: adapting the idea to a more centralized model because of the company culture and stakeholder needs.[Reference-letter-Jimmy-Pang.pdf+1](#)
- Your 30/60/90-day plan was well received: build relationships, map pain points, secure quick wins, then introduce structure and measurable delivery processes.[Reference-letter-Jimmy-Pang.pdf+1](#)
- Daria emphasized that Metrify's biggest issue is **not motivation but lack of supervision and structure**; the team wants to deliver, but needs closer guidance.[linkedin](#)

- She described the current state as **flat and decentralized**, with unclear ownership and weak coordination across the data people.[linkedin](#)
- She asked about your view on **AI**, and you positioned it as a productivity boost that should reshape BI toward more stable semantic layers and more dynamic insight delivery.[Resume.pdf](#)
- She also asked what would be a **deal breaker**, and you said the lack of curiosity is non-negotiable for you.[Resume.pdf](#)
- Near the end, she asked deeper questions about the **relationship between the central energy team and Metrify**, and you learned that the current pain is weak communication, poor response times, and missing operational structure.[linkedin](#)
- She confirmed the hiring manager is **Marcus, the CTO**, and said she would share feedback with Antonia afterward.[linkedin](#)

Net read

- This sounds like a **positive HM interview**.
- Your strongest signal was that you can **impose structure without killing the startup energy**.
- The biggest theme was: **they need a trusted operator who can centralize chaos fast**.

Appendix

Hello. Nice to meet you.

Uh, nice to meet you.

One second. I'm not sure if my camera is on because I want to see myself.

Uh, it is on. I can see you.

Okay. Yeah,

perfect. How are you today?

Well, and I certainly hope um you're doing better than I do because uh the people is definitely coming to Are you based in B as well?

Yes. Yes. Yeah,

I can I cannot believe that I'm saying this, but I'm not very much for the weekend. I mean, last time I checked, it's 40° and now it gets a little bit better. 39 degrees, and there should be rain for the for Sunday, but for Saturday, it's going to be 38 or 39 degrees for the holiday. I am not looking forward to that. Sorry.

I know that's crazy. I also like I think the best way I It's like to stay at home and not go outside because outside I think it's very hard or you on the seaside some Baltics maybe. I don't know.

It's not going to make a huge difference because even by the seaside or by the lake there will be a lot of people fighting over the shade.

So I don't know which one is which one is
anyway we'll get we'll make

that's true. Yeah. It's only one weekend. So after this it's going to be like stormy weather which is quite nice and then some rain coming our direction.

Yeah, definitely. And before we get into the the main dish here, I'm actually a bit curious. Have we have we met somewhere before?

No, no, we haven't. I think we're connected at the LinkedIn, but I truly I was like I was wondering since when uh and and we have some like some common people as contacts, but I think we never met.

Yeah. Yeah. Also, I also have the situation.

Yeah.

We have like 40 other mutual.

Yes.

But have you been working at Wfair?

No, but I have no

I have worked in HelloFresh and I know Fabio is I'm not sure if you have met him, the Italian guy. Uh he was from Wayfair and he also worked in the uh in HelloFresh and that's how we met. company and probably there are plenty of people to be we somehow know separately and they change jobs around around and so on you know at the end of the day it's just a finish
yeah yeah yeah at the end of the day I think like five years ago everyone was working delivery hero hero hello fresh and wafer and now it's yeah it's a new wave but Jimmy

so before we like then let's start with a proper introduction talking I will do a few notes if you don't mind so I can uh make my feedback later easier easily um we

will start with the introduction you go first and I go second and then I will ask some questions based on your experience uh maybe I will ask some technical question but not going into the depth uh of it just some so feel free to start sure it's just let's get right to it first of all nice to meet you again this is Jimmy originally from Hong Kong and uh and I have been for a bit more than seven years and I came for the uh opportunity in delivery hero because I used to work in Hong Kong which was success I'm the delivery hero and then I spent around three years there and then I moved to Harresh as an Olympics and that's where I met um and afterwards I I moved to collective which is a French second marketplace and uh this is also my latest experience in the yeah in both the leadership and also BIL engineering manager and um should I go straight to the what I've done in this position already or you will ask project question afterwards

uh I can ask a bit afterwards so like uh let's go so I will since we also haven't met so far so I'll introduce myself and I joined ENL around like a year ago. First was a team for asset management and in January this year I joined energy team energy similar as metrify. So the position where we're looking at for it's kind of it's like it's a separate entity and it's startup within a start startup. So in um we have our own like finance invoicing department. We have our own like uh small departments and we with our like analysts and uh the data products we support. Jimmy, you have some noise like like squeezing back and forward in the background.

Yeah.

Is it gone now or

now it's better? No, it's still there.

So, I don't know.

Oh, maybe it's coming from my Wait, sorry. Maybe it's coming from my Can you hear me?

Yeah, it's still there. That's weird. Okay, let's try to continue. Um, maybe I just dropped them before our call. So, um, it could be on me.

Okay,

let's see. Um, so, uh, yes, I joined energy this, uh, January this year and, um, I was always curious about energy market, how the energy market works in Germany. I moved to Germany around years ago to study and already like in my um

journey I was working with Vatin pily hats

so fy hats is a great operator for north northeast of Germany and I always want to learn more about energy market and this team is kind of a perfect opportunity for it because you're really like close with the people who are really involved in the market communication you get a really good understanding about all the prices

and the same with the metriy it's seen on its own It's very young motivated team uh currently without team lead. So why we are speaking because in May uh me and one data engineer from my team went to this team and we kind of brought some structure and I got some insight how the team works and this is actually was also part of my communications to CTO of Mriy that they definitely need a team lead to kind of bring order and structure and bring the team forward

and yes this is uh why I was speaking. So Let's go back to you and let's go back to your experience. Can you tell me like how many people actually you are leading and how like u how is the I'm interested how many people you are leading how much hands on and leading managerial work you are doing day-to-day uh and what is like the biggest thing that you changed when for example if we talk about west since you joined

so let's start by answering the first question I was I was from all the way from the from internship to intermediate and to a senior level and um and I handled all the uh screening sessing uh interviewing and on boarding and also mentoring. Uh because of the lack of lack of resources back in the days I had to get very hands on in the whole hiring process and uh and regarding hands on uh there is also fair amount of um chaos And I I mean I did not have any direct reports in the first half year. So I had to bring at least the basic order basic structure the whole chaos and I still remember there is the also to answer the question the what has changed there's a lot of changes actually like the highway one um let's pick the the the table of transportation as as an example transportation here it means the movement outside the warehouse u between the the buyer and seller and it could be from the from the seller to the warehouse or from the warehouse to the to the buyer in a happy path. Uh because in reality it could be very complicated and that's why they need this one source of truth fact table to tell what's the movement of the of the of the product outside the warehouse and um before I joined uh they had something called trans transport table and it was absolutely chaotic. It took super long to run um no idea how comes the physical the logic wasn't clear and uh it got

broken very easily and um and there's also a lot of duplication and unclear primary key there and I have no idea how anyone could make any decision out of it and um I saw the opportunity uh especially after talking to many stakeholders co and transition and also the product engineering etc and uh what I did is I leverage the ongoing um initiative uh at the product engineering side because they also were at the middle of building new microservices called TMS uh that is purely handling the shipment and the trans transportation status and and integration with metac. So we had very great um data sources from microservices by Kafka topic and I was exposing these KA topics and work very closely with the business and say hey this would be the new s of we trust anyway. And this is exactly how we do the data modeling. What does one row record means? It means one. And what is the characteristic? What is the length? Is it coming from the from seller to the warehouse from the the warehouse to the buyer because it was completely uh invisible in the old table and along there was also a lot of limitations and uh and lead time uh which is the probably the most important aspect for the transportation and uh is the carrier uses and the carrier service as in what kind of um what kind of contract we have per carrier. It is very important for the transportation team to know uh if the carrier they still upholding their side of bargains or they need to follow up uh to to to address the performance issue from the carrier. So uh it took some time to to gain the traction uh but eventually I got a very positive feedback uh and it does not come very easily uh because transportation. He has a background from Amazon and Amazon is known for having very good transportation logistics and performance. So yeah, I got a very positive feedback from him saying this is the first time he trust data in in the whole year and it was very robust table as well robust as it has around 12 I think it's 27 uh row components of of the table and uh it also becomes the fifth most popular table to use whole company because it's not just for transportation team, not just for carrier manager but also important for team as well.

So yeah, this was the first example. There are also other examples that is more technical intense due time conraint that's not going into sounds good. And can you tell me something from the team perspective and there is something that like in the past that you like you change direction where the team is going or you were able to convince decision, you know, like something more less technical but more from the leadership perspective. Less technical but from a leadership perspective. Um, let me think I mean to me

because the the position was actually a mix of uh technical leadership is a bit hard to really kind of come here.

Uh but let's take another example of a project I led called mesh pilot. It's basically the first introduction of the of the mesh to um and uh I had to do a lot of customization of the of the model and uh because the ideal ideal design of um of data mesh is fully federal fully decentralized uh but the cultural differences uh in in a French company it's very different they expect a fairly strong central idea and then the satellite team or whatever team they should be some sort of success of the central group. So by nature um by the cultural differences we cannot go through or data match them. Uh so as a alternative after getting a lot of feedback from the stakeholders uh we decided to move to a more emphasizing central architecture and we allowed the business to follow through this uh model. So um that being said was background and how we make it happen is we start um as the business impact especially in terms of the need for speed delivery of new data assets and change of data asset as well which was a very rigid and hard uh demand from the CRM team uh although they were not my primary uh stakeholder it took me a bit more time to to establish the relationship and do a stakehold stakeholder and lobbying eventually we we managed to board they propose and they start out as a six pages explaining the whole business impact and secular mapping and who does what and it was a fairly big project I would say but um but I would say I'm pretty proud of it because later the adoption of the framework and how people are using it um I would say it's pretty nice um there are some further improvement needs to be made for sure for example the cost control and the contention and so on and uh improving the output style and more streamline the CI rather technical what was the most difficult part the whole project was already

so yeah I think this will be

okay thank you so much then uh is it fair estimation that when I think about your work at the last company it was like 50 50% 50% hands-on 50% uh leadership management or would you like corrected

I mean um on paper yes but in reality it shift especially at the very beginning it was mostly it's either 70 to 90% hands on

and yeah after getting the the uh the team the new team on board I would have to do a bit of hands off work to do manager as well

and that took me around 30 to 50% of of the capacity in the my second year

and I can get a bit more hands off and I can also dedicate more work uh for the no matter for my direct report or even my stakeholder as the analyst because of the pilot I so I could be free and do something more critical like the job orchestrations and and convention and also the other foundational topic as well. So yeah I would say it's still fair as a whole and your work and like so far I understand and Tableau most of the time. Okay. Uh DVD Tableau plus airflow and a bit other plugin for DVT as well for examp you were it was say collective till January this year.

Correct.

Okay. And uh then uh right now you are uh like what was the reason of you looking for a different job?

Long story short um the company of this year they have been missing their business target for more than half year by two. Uh that result in a rather drastic uh of change for the whole company. It involved replacement of CEO taking out and my whole data team also got laid off along with the other uh with the other remote people as well. So um

more like

yes

okay got it then maybe the question like when you imagine you now joining the team metrifi and metrifi I mentioned before they didn't have any team that before

so you have like the here is very flat you have the team you have like different data people like in different teams you have like what a few central data people and you have CTO that probably going to be your direct uh manager. So what would be your plan or how would you start your work there?

First of all definitely uh handshake and the relationship building because nothing will work without proper relationship. Second um also along this first two weeks uh during the handshake I need to know what are the wish list from all of the stakeholders including the the data people as well and more importantly is what are the pain points what are people struggle with the current setup at the moment and then uh I would um try to secure a couple of quick means to gain traction and also establish the um establish cred credibility to gain more trust from stakeholders and also along with the data data teams as well. So that would be uh critical first months and first 30 days and from the first 30 to 16 days um I should start having some sort of a basic idea of usually what dynamic of the company would be and what would make sense to start

having the structure with uh maybe it's a bit too early to bring up the idea of of a chapter but there has to be some sort of collaboration structure amongst all the people I would just get together not with the stakeholder even though they're important but we have to stick together on a regular basis let it be weekly or or bi-weekly basis uh we have the joint power to to to see if there's any struggle of ours could be consolidated or we could address this kind of struggle in a systematic way that would be the 30 to 60 uh days for me and that's something that's also a very important element to have just one list of of all from all the stakeholder uh because uh it is naturally very very chaotic if the business are moving so fast and there are so many people working on different things. It's natural to have silos. It's important to have just one place to store all the requests and uh and have a proper priority and agree with the stakeholders and preliminary uh how do we measure the impact and how do we decide what what got work on first and what is to wait

and uh and I'm not sure if there's alorgan or scrum in place already. know that I will also have to introduce um scrum to for better expectation management for all the stakeholders to let them know when could they when they expect a certain delivery of a of a project um or maybe it's still too early so I need to gauge that dynamic in the first activity

and um if no I will still have to stick to that then I will have to measure the team performance in terms of the speed of delivery as in how long does it take from ticket being created and until the point it actually got resolved. Then then from 60 days to 90 days um that would be more solidified and start asking for feedback and retrospective with the with the stakeholders and also with the with the team and um and and see if there's any pivot we need to make on the fly and of course along the along the flight the management expression and namely the CEO will be very critical in the process and um and as there will be a lot of problem it will be a lot of it's a lot easier to be solved with the leadership blessing as well

so yeah uh I think I cover the first

it's very very you gave a very specific answer did you face similar situation before or how were you able to sum up all the step in such a short uh time let's say I went for similar twice and then I also read the book of first 90 days and I think it's a pretty good read and it it was actually a gift from another good friend of mine who is now I think he's head of data engineering and data science hero

and uh combine that knowledge with uh with what I went through myself in one of the example I told you is a transition and other problem is I went through something similar in both propenda and also hero um with multiple profile stakeholder like business product operation uh product uh product owner product managers and also the engineers and of course executives as well so I myself

okay got it and then uh one last question from me how are you like what is your position about AI and how AI will affect like business intelligence job overall in general and in AI in your everyday work.

Okay, so let's start from the highest level.

In short, uh my take on AI is going to boost the productivity for humans a lot much like what the technology has been doing for us like like for example the finance uh tech like um myobi and sage which used to be known as a tree for the finance team that would team of four to five people be able to do what used to take around 100 or 200 people.

So I imagine that it's going to be the same uh and and to be specific in BI and that I need to borrow the wisdom from another data leader I know from textics Andre and Andre has a very good point here and um usually for executive dashboard for the highest level of dashboard especially for them they would be um being used over and over again those would be stay permanent and they should stay there. By default for data visualization in business intelligence by default the data visualization should be even marrow and being generated on the fly and from what I observed from the industry as well especially from from the movement snowflake activity uh it seems that the theatic layers finally get traction after four years discussion and um and it's also open standard as well so there should be a proper construction on the layer and train the on top of the layer and the submit should also be kept up to date from time to time usually from analytics engineers or maybe from BI as well and depending on the ownership but the point is it should be served as a as the layer and let the business people gain the insight on the fly especially if they are focusing on the operational frontline ground so that's how I see it

nice Thank you so much. Then one last question from my side and then we go to your question. I have few minutes after our call free. So we can save a bit over time if it's fine for you as well.

So one question, what would be a no goal for you? Like which team would you not like to join at all?

Um the one deal breaker for me is the lack of curiosity I would say and I think that is a non-negotiable for anyone who works in data or tech especially in the AI that means uh the tool to tools could change even for principles best practice like dimensional modeling or wing it could also change but what wouldn't change is the curiosity that is a very uh I wouldn't say so but that is the primary motivation for anyone to stay relevant uh for in in the in the game of data in the game of tech for longer run and um of course there would also be other um other characteristics that are relevant and important here. Like for example, the disciplines all all through with the same with the same development and resilience as well because there will be a lot of failure across the trial and error. It's part of learning and um but I would say the lack of curiosity is really something I cannot work around and I have unfortunately I went through myself and it's really drained my energy which more useful and better places.

So yes, I would say lack of curiosity.

Got it. Got it. Okay. Thank you. Then uh let's uh let's start with your questions like do you have any?

I actually want to dig a little bit deeper around the relationship between you and the current data team in metric. Could you tell me a bit more about the history and what kind of uh structure have you have you brought to the team? So um originally uh we in energy team sometimes we need the data from metrify. So metrify it's um MSB in German is mesh in the fiber. So they work with the smart meter and they have some data available on customer level or readings like 15 minutes data consumption in production. That's also important for example for energy finance team because there we we have forecast as well because we buy energy like um we can buy energy like two years ahead. So we need to make sure okay how our focus working compared to actuals and this actuals we for example were getting from metrified team and uh so we have some like data requests that are going from time to time to them and we were facing the future a huge bottleneck there because currently it was like kind of one person responsible for it and we didn't even know like what is his block or why he is not responding why he's not delivering the deadlines for communicating very poorly. So for example, he will say I will deliver it on Wednesday and on Friday we will actually figure out that the process of even like talking to the legal department is haven't even started. So you know like besides like when you talk personally with the people like so we didn't have this relationship we didn't have this trust. So that's why like around month ago me and one data engineer

from my team we just went there to kind of to see like what is going on and how can we make for example, we're not getting blocked and then and improve their structure because to be honest with this flat hair it's like they didn't have anyone to kind of show them best practice and this data person is around he has like one year of data engineering experience so he's very smart intelligent motivated and curious and you know like willing to work but it's like it's just a lot what is going on in the team and I think it's like it's hard to navigate if no one can step aside and can bring the order so what we did I built automation because one of the concerns they raised they don't have time to create ticket. So I built them automation for the channel that the ticket is creating automatically. So this was one step we made sure that they're using the Azure board. So we work with Kanban. We implemented like weekly um connects within the data team. I got the whole overview of the old data people in the team and trying to understand you know who is doing what and so on. So this was and after implementing we enabled them as so we did some We brought some structure on the like project management side and after this we kind of went back but we have this relationship with them. So now we know kind of how to proceed if something slightly not getting delivered.

Okay. Interesting. I got some uh rough understanding here but I want to even deeper. What would you describe as the biggest challenge and opportunity in the current state of uh of

uh this challenging opportunity and it's really like it's you know there are a lot of low hanging fruits there. It's like what you mentioned in your plan that first 30 days that you're first like building the trust and then you're doing like all other steps and then you have quick wins and you have a lot of quick wins there because actually like the team is just I mean they decentralized if you bring all the team together because right now like sometimes when I need something I just go up to another like floor and talk in person then I get it. But I cannot be there all the time, right? And I it's not my job and I also don't want to force myself into this position of taking this uh second team. So for me it's important that like um you will have this challenge of people having habit of working in the way they work

because again they are super motivated, curious and you will and when you will notice once you enter and pal you see this mood of like people want to deliver something. a question of motivation. It's question of lack of supervision and someone to be really close with them and kind of building this trust with the

team but also what you mentioned and it's very important to understand what is actually the goal of the team what is the wish of stakeholder where should we go from the leadership perspective

I mean I got uh some feeling from that uh from uh you know the previous presentation from how especially from the DBT meetup and so on I mean well thank you for the insight for more details and what else I think I have most of my questions at the moment thank you

no it's fine no worries if you have any additional question you can let Antonia know and I will also summarize my feedback and I will reach out to her to provide it to her and she will come back to you

sure actually one last quick question if I'm not mistaken the hiring manager is actually the CTO Marcus Marcus it

yeah

you know sir

no

I mean I just uh roughly remember this maybe I don't know maybe

okay got it got yeah

thank you thank you Jimmy for taking your time and then uh yeah have a nice day survive the heat take care of you on the weekend

oh yeah you too

have a nice one by Bye-bye.

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